6.13 Colorectal Cancer*

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "I have lost weight and do not feel like eating." **Objective** • Lost 6 kg in 3 months • Hb 9.5 g/dL • Low albumin	**ACTUAL** Inadequate nutritional intake related to the disease process and reduced intake as evidenced by weight loss and hypoalbuminemia.	• Weight maintained or rising before surgery or treatment.	• Screen nutrition on admission. • Refer to the dietitian for supplements. • Offer small, frequent high-protein meals. • Weigh twice a week. • Give iron or blood for anemia as prescribed.	• Goal reached if weight is stable or increasing.
Subjective • "I am frightened of having a bag." • "Will the cancer come back?" **Objective** • Tearful • Sleeping poorly	**ACTUAL** Excessive anxiety related to a cancer diagnosis and possible stoma as evidenced by expressed fear and insomnia.	• Voices her concerns and reports less anxiety before surgery.	• Give time for questions and listen carefully. • Arrange a pre-operative visit from the stoma nurse for siting. • Give clear information together with the medical team. • Involve the family as she wishes.	• Met when she says she feels better prepared.
Subjective *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Bowel resection planned • Anemia • Low albumin	**RISK** Risk for surgical wound infection as evidenced by risk factors: bowel surgery, anemia and malnutrition.	• Wound heals without infection or signs of anastomotic leak.	• Give prophylactic antibiotics as ordered. • Watch the wound, drain output and temperature. • Report fever, worsening abdominal pain or tachycardia, which may mean a leak.	• Achieved if no infection develops.

*References for this care plan: [7], [32], [35], [37], [55]. Full entries are listed in the References section of the CPMN book.